

U.T. El Paso Spends Less For Sports

George McCarty, athletic director at the University of Texas at El Paso, Friday led Downtown Lions backstage in discussing the economics of the school's athletic program as it is preparing to enter the Western Athletic Conference.

Addressing the club in the Plaza Motor Hotel, McCarthy said the U.T. El Paso budget for its entire athletic program is \$600,000 a year, none of it paid from university funds. There are 18 paid employees in connection with the budget, he said, and 97 per cent of the money is spent in El Paso. The food bill alone was \$11,187 for October.

By comparison, the schools with the next lowest budget, among the six now in the WAC, spent \$367,000 on its athletic program last year, while Arizona State University budgeted \$1,250,000. To meet the local budget, McCarthy pointed out, it is necessary to schedule some games away from home that might be played here, because of the financial advantage.

A sell-out for the Wyoming game Saturday night in the Sun Bowl is assured, but admission tickets will be sold to all who show up, for standing room or seating space at ends of the stadium.

McCarty disclosed that Lion Andy Cohen, former big league baseball player, coaches the Miners baseball team without salary through the courtesy of his employer. He also told the Lions that it will be 1977, because of previous scheduling, before a complete round robin schedule of football games can be played among the expanded eight-team WAC, with baseball games already scheduled through 1980.

The basketball move to El Paso County Coliseum assures a much larger attendance and a needed enlargement of receipts while providing for the student body, McCarthy said. The Coliseum will seat 8,414 for basketball and season tickets already have been sold for all but 1,600.

Turning to the track program, McCarthy said 10 members of the Miners team have been invited to the Melrose games in New York and to Philadelphia.